



- The central image is more informal with positive codes of gesture and expression. The use of the pun in the caption, 'NICE TO SEE EU' highlights what appears to be the positive relationship between Keir Starmer and Ursula von de Leyen.
- The boxes across the top of the page with their individual sub-headings catch the eye and are a positive list, reflecting the viewpoint of the newspaper and its support of the PM. They set out clearly '*How Britain is set to benefit from accord*'. The newspaper has selected aspects of the deal that will be of relevance to their lower middle/working-class audience, including electricity, policing and youth mobility.
- The language used across the double-page spread varies according to the writer and purpose. The main piece of copy links to the central headline and attempts to clearly explain the complexities of the deal while reassuring readers of its importance for them as it offers '*practical benefits for ordinary people fed up of years of Brexit wrangling*'. There are also references to the deal being discussed whilst eating a Nando's, making the politicians and negotiators seem more approachable and relatable to the readers.
- The **opinion pieces** adopt a more informal **mode of address**. Kevin Maguire, a regular *Daily Mirror* columnist can be more forthright and biased in his treatment of the story. This is evident in the language he employs using a pejorative portmanteau noun, referring to '*Brexetremists frothing at the mouth*' and '*lying con-man Boris Johnson's bad Brexit*'. David Lammy (Foreign Secretary at the time) writes in a more formal, controlled style in his column, but makes his positive opinion of the deal clear. The choice of his inclusion as a member of the Labour government writing in the newspaper reinforces its support for the government and its policies. The insert image emphasises his central role in the government and his closeness to the PM therefore his opinion is relevant.

Theoretical perspectives

Semiotics – Roland Barthes

- The newspaper pages use **signs and codes** that are recognisable to audiences and connote meanings. Consider how the use of colour and the codes of clothing and expression communicate meaning and reinforce the ideas and viewpoint of the newspaper in relation to the main story.
- The meanings constructed by the newspaper can come to seem self-evident. The left-wing political viewpoint of the *Daily Mirror* will be regularly reinforced through the stories that are chosen and the way in which they are mediated. This will generally be accepted by the readers who share the newspaper's political ideology.

Structuralism – Levi-Strauss (A Level)

- Newspapers are recognisable to all audiences by their form; they have a repertoire of elements that communicate meaning regardless of their style or political allegiance, for example a masthead, strong central image and main headline.
- Newspapers also communicate meanings through constructing **binary oppositions**, for example the *Daily Mirror* presents a left-wing viewpoint and is in direct and obvious opposition to the more right-wing Conservative Party. The newspaper, in the way that it mediates the stories it selects constructs a good/bad opposition between the two parties.
- The resolution of oppositions in newspapers positions the reader to identify with the newspaper's ideology. A newspaper like the *Daily Mirror* makes its viewpoint explicit.